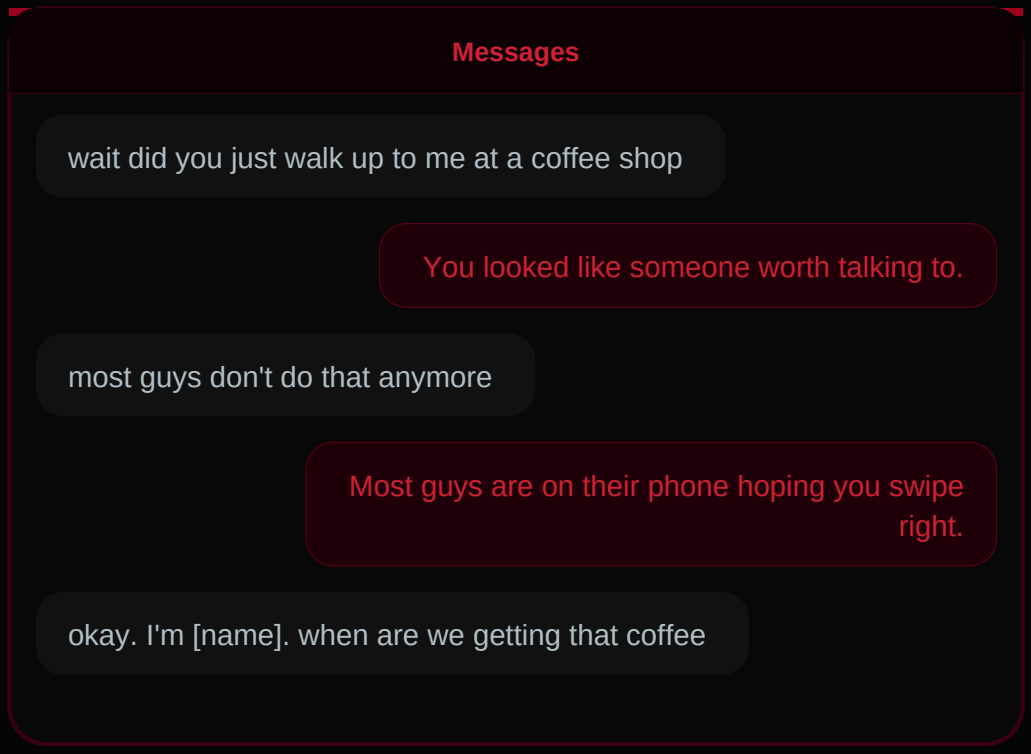
THE SHORT KING SERIES

BOOK FIVE

# Approach Like a King

*The Short Man's Real-World Program for Killing Approach Anxiety Forever*

| 5 | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| SEE HER | DECIDE | COUNT | MOVE | NOW |




**The Step-by-Step System That Turns Approaching Into a Skill, Not a Gamble.**

The Short King Coaching

## WHO THIS IS FOR

> *"Every man who dates has a woman he didn't approach. This book makes sure you stop adding to that list."*

This book is for the man who freezes. The one who sees her across the bar, the coffee shop, the street, and spends sixty seconds running an internal negotiation that ends with him not moving. The one who gets home, opens a dating app, and thinks about the girl he didn't talk to.

Approach anxiety is the single biggest gap between the dating life a shorter man could have and the one he actually has. Not height. Not looks. Not money. **The willingness to close the distance between where he's standing and where she is.** This book is the system that closes that gap permanently.

### How This Book Connects

Book Three built the internal confidence. Book Four built the presence. This book is where both go to work in a real approach. If you're coming to this book cold, it still works on its own — but everything compounds faster when the internal and presence work is already in place. For the text game after you get the number, go back to Book One. For first date execution, Book Two has you covered.

INTRODUCTION

# The Approach Is the Whole Game

Every dating strategy in this series assumes one thing: that you actually talked to her first. And for a large percentage of men, that assumption is the problem.

Apps help. But apps filter aggressively for height. They remove context, personality, voice, and presence from the equation and replace them with a photograph and a number. **The man who can approach in person bypasses all of those filters and puts himself in front of the woman directly** — where everything he's built in this series can actually be felt.

For shorter men specifically, the in-person approach is where the playing field levels most dramatically. Presence, voice, humor, warmth, directness — all of these come through in an approach in ways they simply cannot in a profile. I've watched 5'5" men approach and close conversations that no dating app algorithm would have predicted as possible. The approach is where the Short King wins.

> *"Approach anxiety isn't a personality trait. It's a habit. And like every habit, it can be replaced with a better one through consistent, deliberate repetition."*

CHAPTER ONE

# Why Your Brain Fights You

*The Neuroscience of the Freeze and How to Override It*

You see her. A signal fires. Your chest tightens slightly. Your mind starts running calculations at speed: what if she's with someone? What if I say the wrong thing? What if she's not interested and everyone sees it? By the time that loop has run twice you've already decided it's not the right moment — and the moment has passed.

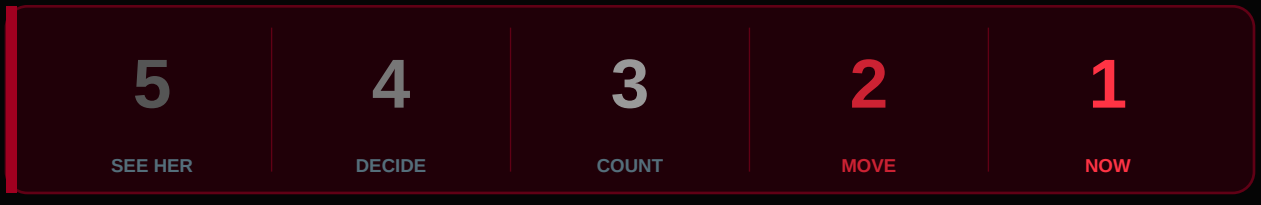
This is not weakness. This is your amygdala doing exactly what it was built to do: detecting social threat and generating an avoidance response. In evolutionary terms, approaching an unknown person you're attracted to and whose rejection carries social stakes genuinely resembles a threat scenario. The brain doesn't distinguish between physical danger and social danger with any sophistication. It just fires the response.

The problem is that habituation — the process by which repeated exposure degrades a threat response — requires you to actually approach. Every time you don't approach, the amygdala records: *threat avoided, response reinforced.* Every time you do approach, it records: *threat engaged, outcome survivable, threat level lower.*

## The Override Mechanism

Mel Robbins documented this mechanism in her work on the five-second rule: the prefrontal cortex has approximately a five-second window to override an avoidance instinct before the amygdala locks the decision. After five seconds of not moving, the brain categorizes the situation as decided and the window closes.

**The solution is not to eliminate the anxiety response. The solution is to act before the five-second window closes — every single time, without exception, regardless of how the anxiety feels. The action precedes the comfort. The comfort follows the action. Men who wait until they feel comfortable to approach never approach.**



### THE FIVE-SECOND TRIGGER

You notice her and decide to approach.

Count internally: **5 — 4 — 3 — 2 — 1**

On 1 you move. **Not after 1. On 1.**

The counting is a pattern interrupt — it occupies the prefrontal cortex so the amygdala cannot complete its avoidance loop before your feet are already moving.

Once your feet are moving the anxiety drops sharply. The anticipation is almost always worse than the approach.

### ◆ CASE STUDY: REAL CASE: THE FIRST APPROACH

*A client at 5'6" described his approach pattern as perfect in his head and nonexistent in real life. He could visualize exactly what he would say. He had never actually done it. We introduced one rule only for the first week: no analysis, no preparation, no waiting for the right moment. See her, count to five, move. His first approach on day two lasted eleven seconds before she indicated she was waiting for someone. He described the walk back as the best he'd felt in months. Not because it went well — because the thing he'd been afraid of for years took eleven seconds and left him completely fine. By day seven he had approached six women. By the end of the month he had two numbers and one date. The anxiety didn't disappear. It just stopped being in charge.*

### ■ YOUR MOVE

Commit to the five-second rule for the next seven days. Every time you notice an attractive woman in a real-world environment and feel the pull to approach, count 5-4-3-2-1 and move. Do not negotiate with the anxiety. Do not wait for the perfect opener. Move first and let the words come after. Log every approach: location, what you said, what happened.